Avatars of the Shattered Realms

Game Design Document v2.2

Last Updated: Early Development — Pre-Production

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1. GAME OVERVIEW

Elevator Pitch

A grind-forward turn-based RPG set in a post-victory world where the heroes already won, death isn't permanent, and fighting is just a way of life. Collect Legends from shattered realities, rebuild your lost power from scratch, and push through an infinite loop of nodes, loot, and escalating strength. The grind isn't a means to an end — it IS the game.

Core Fantasy

You already won once. You got soft. Now start over and become something even greater.

Tone

Completely unhinged and self-aware. Robots cast fireballs. Ninjas fight soldiers. Henry Stickmin exists. Death is a minor inconvenience. Nobody questions any of it. The game knows what it is and leans in.

World Theme — Fighting as a Way of Life

The BBeg is dead. The kingdom is thriving. And death isn't permanent — anyone who dies respawns at the location they fell within 3 to 7 days. This has completely changed society's relationship with combat. Fighting isn't feared — it's a passion, a craft, a lifestyle. Like extreme sports but the extreme sport IS combat and everyone is completely fine with this. Bandits aren't murderers, they're just people who chose a rougher hobby. Battles are how people socialize, settle disputes, test themselves, and have fun. The world APPROVES of fighting as a way of life.

The Level Loss Problem

The original four defeated the BBeg years ago and were rewarded with everything they wanted. In the years since, with no battles to fight, their skills atrophied and their levels faded — use it or lose it. Specifically:

- **Fighter** — spent years eating spicy meat, tending his favorite vegetables, and enjoying endless Elven and Human concubines. The craft of combat faded completely.
- **Thief** — was deactivated and used as a vacuum cleaner. His combat routines literally weren't running.

- **Mage** — was in his tower vibe casting. Kept SOME magical ability but the battle-tested edge is gone.
- **Cleric** — probably maintained the most. Healing never fully stops being useful.

They're starting over. Not because they have to. Because they WANT to.

Inspirations

- Combat feel: Persona 5
- Node progression: Warframe
- Loot system: Borderlands
- Roster depth: Disgaea
- Color/element system: Magic: The Gathering (loosely)
- Power ceiling: None

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2. STORY & WORLD

Setting

Fighter's Kingdom and the Shattered Realms — what remains of countless realities torn apart by a cosmic-level villain (the BBeg). The original four already won. The kingdom is peaceful and prosperous. But the shattering that happened during the conflict left cracks in reality that are still there, still growing, and still spilling the remnants of other worlds into this one.

Death & Respawning

Death is not permanent in this world. Anyone who dies respawns at the location they fell within 3 to 7 days. This is known, accepted, and has shaped an entire culture around combat as a consequence-free way of life. Nobody is truly afraid of dying — it's an inconvenience, not a tragedy. This is why the entire world approves of fighting.

The Shattering

An entity of immense power (the BBeg, details TBD) shattered multiple realities to harvest their power, legends, or something worse. The avatars of each realm — their greatest heroes — were scattered across the wreckage. The original four stopped the first BBeg years ago. But the shattering already happened and the cracks remain. Something new may be stirring in the aftermath.

Realm Progression

- Early Game: Fighter's home realm — classic fantasy kingdom, the starting zone
- Early Game (post-Mage): The Shattering event occurs — Henry Stickmin faceplants next to the party and joins
- Mid Game: Heaven and Hell realms open (separate zones, separate nodes, everyone wants to fight)
- Mid Game (after Heaven and Hell): RGB Realm and BW (Black and White) Realm unlock
- Late Game: Push toward the source of the shattering, face the true threat
- Endgame: Infinite node scaling, uncapped grind, new realms TBD

Realm Aesthetics & Identities

Realm	Aesthetic	Unique Rule	Notes
Fighter's Kingdom	Classic Fantasy	None (tutorial realm)	Starting zone
Heaven	Holy / Divine	TBD — White color amplified	Separate from Hell, everyone wants to fight
Hell	Dark / Infernal	TBD — Black color amplified	Separate from Heaven, everyone wants to fight
RGB Realm	Vibrant Chaos	TBD — Red/Green/Blue color interactions	Loud, unpredictable, effects everywhere
BW Realm	Cold, Calculated	TBD — Black/White color interactions	Stripped down, precise, forces fundamentals
Military Realm	Tactical / Modern	TBD	Home of Super Soldier
Sci-Fi Realm	Space / Tech	TBD	Home of Space Bounty Hunter
Ninja / Feudal	TBD	TBD	TBD
Henry's Realm	Stickmin Universe	TBD	Was shattered. Henry fell out.
Minecraft Realm	Blocky / Modded	TBD	Home of DW20, CaptainSparklez, ShootingDragon + 1 TBD

Realm	Aesthetic	Unique Rule	Notes
Hyrule	Fantasy / Zelda	TBD	Link, Toon Link, Young Link, Zelda, Tetra, Ganon, Impa
Metroid Realm	Sci-Fi / Space	TBD	Samus, Dark Samus, Metroid Prime
More TBD			

BBeg Invasion — Wave Structure

The BBeg's attack hits every realm simultaneously in four distinct waves. Each wave escalates the threat before the Echo arrives.

Wave 1 — Eternal Night All realms simultaneously. The sun stops. Stars freeze. Purple bruising at the sky's edges. Passive and wrong. Nobody knows what it is yet.

Wave 2 — The Crack A massive fracture tears open in the sky of every realm. Through it — visible, undeniable — Fighter's home realm. The legends can see another world through the crack. Nothing comes through. It's a window. The BBeg isn't hiding anymore. They WANT to be seen. Fighter's side sees the same cracks showing glimpses of other worlds — he doesn't know what he's looking at yet.

Wave 3 — Enhanced Enemies Existing enemies in every realm get supercharged. Corrupted. Stronger, faster, wrong. Passive mobs turn aggressive then start attacking each other. Travel becomes dangerous. The legends are pinned down and worn down before the Echo even arrives.

Wave 4 — Echo Tau Arrives The Echo doesn't announce itself. It's just there. The real fight begins.

Echo Tau

Working name for the BBeg's agent sent to neutralize legends. Not a beam — an active hunter. It adapts, repositions, and KNOWS what the legends are trying to do. It watched before it struck. When Dire tries to reach his crafting bench, Echo Tau cuts him off — because it already knows what's on that bench.

Visual design: Completely breaks the visual language of whatever realm it enters. No blocky textures in the Minecraft realm, no pixel art rules. Smooth, alien, wrong proportions, unsettling colors. It looks like something from a different art style entirely. The visual clash IS the horror.

Fighter and the main cast will look equally out of place when they eventually enter other realms — visually foreign just like Echo Tau was. Intentional parallel.

Realm Unlock Cutscenes — Design Rules

These are PROPOSED intros for characters — subject to revision as development progresses.

Every realm unlock opens with a cutscene showing that realm's legends across a four wave escalation — building up through gear tiers, not going straight to best equipment. The legends are genuinely threatening to Echo Tau. They make it WORK. They still lose.

Cutscene structure per realm:

1. Normal day — mundane opening, character doing their thing
2. Wave 1 hits — Eternal Night, passive reaction
3. Wave 2 — The Crack appears, acknowledgement
4. Wave 3 — Enhanced enemies, gear escalation begins
5. Wave 4 — Echo Tau arrives, full fight, final gear reached mid-battle
6. The Fall — earned, not cheap

Hyrule Cutscene — PROPOSED

- Link perfect-reflects Echo Tau's attacks repeatedly, forcing it to adapt
- Forces Echo Tau to split attacks and come from multiple angles
- Link holds — until a sneak attack from behind gets him
- Zelda immediately activates Nayru's Love — divine diamond shield, holding
- The magic cracks. Then shatters. Zelda frozen.
- Establishes: Link was genuinely TROUBLESOME. Echo Tau had to work for it.

Metroid Cutscene — TBD (Samus, Dark Samus, Metroid Prime)

Minecraft Realm Cutscenes — PROPOSED INTROS

These are proposed character introduction cutscenes subject to revision.

The Minecraft realm cutscenes are rendered in full Minecraft pixel art aesthetic — blocky textures, pixel art sprites, looks like a modded let's play recording. Echo Tau breaks this visual entirely — smooth, alien, wrong. The contrast is intentional.

The Engineer's Eclipse — Direwolf20 — PROPOSED INTRO *Location: The 9x9 Forest Outpost*

A peaceful forest. Birdsong. A perfectly flat clearing.

"Hello everyone, this is Direwolf20! Welcome back to the let's play. Today we're starting fresh — new world, new modpack, anonymous viewer suggestion. Let's see what we've got."

He punches a tree. Gets one log.

"Okay. We're gonna need more than that."

— 17 Episodes Later —

Dire steps outside in Farrocore armor. Behind him the mountain has a door now. The sun is gone — eternal night. A sheep charges him. He sidesteps it without breaking stride.

"Passive mobs are acting aggressive. External corruption modifier, probably. I'll look into it after I finish the sorting system."

— 19 Episodes Later —

Dire in Blazegold. The base has expanded. A proper wall now. He looks up.

The sky cracks. Another world visible through it. Castles. Sunlight on the other side that his world no longer has.

"...That's interesting." He pulls out a scanner. Makes a note. Goes back inside.

— 30 Episodes Later —

Full Celestagem. The base is enormous. The crack is background noise now — he's filled half a journal with notes about it. Enhanced mobs move in formations outside the wall. Passive mobs attack each other in the fields.

On the crafting table — Eclipse Alloy armor. Complete. Every piece fully upgraded. Creative flight module crafted and ready to apply.

He looks at it. Looks at his Celestagem.

"I'll put it on after this next run."

— 10 Episodes Later —

Dire steps outside. Celestagem. Scanner in hand. Enhanced mobs have pulled back from the perimeter. The crack pulses.

Echo Tau drops in.

It stands in his carefully maintained clearing looking at his base the way someone looks at something they're about to delete.

Dire scans it immediately.

"External entity. Non-native. Corruption index is... that's the highest reading I've gotten."

He closes the scanner. Looks at Echo Tau. Looks back at the door. At the Eclipse Alloy and the flight module sitting on the crafting table just inside.

Looks back at Echo Tau.

"...Celestagem should be fine."

It is not fine.

Echo Tau hits him like a freight train. Dire TRAVELS — skips across his own base floor, crashes through an interior wall.

He looks up. The sorting room. Not enough mass.

Another hit — through another wall. The automated farm. Wrong type of force.

He takes an enchanted golden apple from his belt without looking. Bites into it while getting up. Half a heart. Regeneration kicks in just as the next strike drops him back down.

He runs.

Through the sorting room — no.
Past the ME drives — no.
Around the smeltery expansion — no.

Echo Tau clips him from behind. Through a wall he spent four episodes building. Lands hard.

He looks up.

The reactor room.

He's never mentioned it on camera. The cables running neat and precise. The SCRAM system wired in on day one. Because you always wire in the SCRAM system on day one.

He looks at the reactor. At the SCRAM wire. At Echo Tau stepping through the hole in the wall.

Last apple. Half a heart.

"I always said I'd never use this."

He pulls the wire.

Pulls out the portal gun. Shoots a portal through the wall at the crafting bench. Exit portal at his feet.

Steps through.

Behind him — white.

The reactor makes a sound no IC2 reactor should ever make.

He's at the bench. Ingredients still laid out. Hands steady. The explosion hasn't reached this room yet but the walls are shaking and the ME system is screaming alerts.

He slots the final piece. Flight module materializes.

"That's still not vanilla behavior."

Eclipse Alloy goes on piece by piece. Boots. Leggings. Chestplate. Helmet. The Celestagem falls away in pieces — already cracked, already done. Shatters on the floor. He doesn't look at it.

The explosion hits the far end of the base. Half his builds — gone.

Dire rises off the ground for the first time. Hovers. Checks inventory.

One enchanted golden apple left.

Echo Tau walks through the smoke. Slower now. For the first time since it came through the roof — surprised.

Dire looks at it.

"You picked the wrong base."

The fight that follows is the longest of the cutscene. Eclipse Alloy and creative flight vs an Echo that now has to genuinely work for it. Dire treats every exchange like an engineering problem — testing, adapting, one apple keeping him alive.

It's not enough.

The sound of Eclipse Alloy fracturing. One crack. Then several.

"Take it easy, everyone."

A trophy solidifies where he stood. Wrench in his hand. Journal open to the last page of notes. Scanner broken.

Through the open door with the doormat — his machines keep running.

On the crafting table, untouched, the ingredients for a second flight module still laid out.

He never grabbed the backup materials.

The Trial of the Void — CaptainSparklez — PROPOSED INTRO *Location: Floating Gravel Island (Void World) (Full cutscene TBD — follows same four wave escalation structure. Jordan escalates from basic gear through Dianite Armor to OreSpawn Ultimate Armor. Final sign-off: "Aww Man" fading into the void as he crystallizes.)*

The Alchemist's Stand — ShootingDragon — PROPOSED INTRO *Location: The Transmutation Lab (Deep Underground) (Full cutscene TBD — follows same four wave escalation structure. ShootingDragon escalates through EMC tiers to Gem Armor and Red Matter gear. Frozen in defiant defensive stance, faint red glow fading.)*

ShootingDragon unlock note: Trophy is LOCKED behind an EMC cost. Most powerful character in the Minecraft realm but requires significant in-game currency investment to rescue. ProjectE logic applied to the rescue mechanic.

4th Minecraft Legend — TBD (not a boss, not a player character)

Endgame Vision — New Tabuu (Working Name)

The final boss is not designed to be defeated by a partial roster. Every rescued legend contributes something specific that others cannot replicate. The fight has phases that require:

- Specific color combinations
- Specific attack categories
- Character-unique abilities (Link's reflection, Samus's beams, Ganon's dark power, Chief's shield, Mario & Luigi's Bro Moves)
- Henry Stickmin does something inexplicable that works anyway

ShootingDragon — the secret 21st, found only after rescuing everyone — closes out the fight with Red Matter gear.

The thematic payoff: The BBeg froze every legend because they were threats. He was right — each one alone wasn't enough. That's WHY he froze them. But all of them together is something he never calculated for. Because he looked at the original four at the start and saw four washed-up has-beens not worth freezing.

That was his mistake.

Visual & Audio Pipeline

Confirmed tools for development:

Asset Type	Tool	Notes
Main game sprites & animation	Piskel	2.5D pixel art, hand crafted
Minecraft realm assets	Blockbench	Blocky aesthetic, exports GLTF to Godot
Echo Tau & main cast	Piskel	Breaks Minecraft visual language intentionally
Music composition	LMMS	Free DAW, similar concept to GarageBand
Game engine	Godot 4	GDScript, single developer

Note: Placeholder assets first, final art later. Build the game before perfecting the visuals.

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3. STORY — ACT 1 OUTLINE

The Setup

Fighter, the greatest hero of his realm, defeated the BBeg and was given a legendary retirement. A lush estate. A life of comfort. Gorgeous women. Everything a hero could want.

He was bored out of his mind.

Beat 1 — The Escape

Fighter ignores his concubines, walks out the front door, and is immediately ambushed by bandits too stupid to recognize who he is. He gets captured and thrown in jail. He is not particularly worried about this.

Beat 2 — Thief

While exploring the bandit hideout, Fighter finds a closet. Inside is a deactivated robot — Thief, his old party member, purchased from a pawn broker by the bandit leader who believed he was buying a vacuum cleaner. Fighter turns him on. Brief reunion.

Beat 3 — The Bandit Leader's Sweetheart

The reunion is cut short when the bandit leader's sweetheart shows up. First real boss fight. She survives and limps away — establishing her as a recurring antagonist with a personal grudge against Fighter.

Beat 4 — Node Clearing

Fighter and Thief push through a handful of nodes. The world opens up. The grind begins.

Beat 5 — Cleric

They encounter Cleric mid-combat. She's already dealing with the bandit leader AND an empowered Sweetheart (second encounter, she came back stronger). They fight together. Party grows to three.

Beat 6 — Mage

A tower is nearby. Fighter drags Mage out of it. Mage complains the entire time. He comes anyway. The original four are reunited.

Beat 7 — The Shattering & Henry Stickmin

Some time after Mage joins, the Shattering event hits. Henry Stickmin falls face-first out of the sky and lands next to the party. He joins. No further explanation is given or needed.

Act 1 End

The original party is back plus Henry. The scope of the shattering becomes clear. The real journey starts.

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4. THE COLOR SYSTEM

Overview

Every special attack in the game belongs to one of five colors. Colors serve as both an elemental type system AND a mechanical identity. Characters have two colors — a primary and a secondary. Primary color skills are learned naturally and deal boosted damage/effects. Secondary color gives access to some skills with a smaller or no buff. Enemies have weaknesses and resistances tied to the color system.

The Five Colors

Color	Element	Mechanical Identity	Skill flavor
Red	Fire	Aggression, burn DoT, high damage, fast skills, low cost	Offensive, impulsive, direct
Blue	Water / Ice	Freeze, slow, debuffs, turn manipulation, resource drain, control	Calculated, reactive, disruptive
Green	Earth / Nature	Regen, stat buffs, brute force hits, high HP scaling	Endurance, growth, overwhelming force

Color	Element	Mechanical Identity	Skill flavor
White	Holy	Healing, shields, buffs, status cleanse, resurrection	Order, protection, unity
Black	Unholy	Life drain, DEF-piercing damage, status infliction, sacrifice HP for power	Ambition, corruption, self-advancement

Dual Color Rules

- Every character has exactly two colors
- Primary color: character learns these skills by default, gets a damage/effect buff
- Secondary color: partial skill access, smaller or no buff
- Color identity shapes build direction and party composition decisions

Color Interaction Chart

The Elemental Triangle (RGB)

Attacker	Defender	Modifier
Red	Green	2x damage
Green	Red	0.5x damage
Green	Blue	2x damage
Blue	Green	0.5x damage
Blue	Red	2x damage
Red	Blue	0.5x damage

Holy vs Unholy (BW)

Attacker	Defender	Modifier
White	Black	2x damage
Black	White	2x damage

No resistance in either direction — White and Black purely amplify damage against each other. Neither reduces incoming damage from the other.

Cross-System

- RGB colors have no bonus or penalty against White or Black
- White and Black have no interaction with the elemental triangle
- The two systems coexist independently

Enemy Color Interactions

- Enemies have one or more color weaknesses and resistances based on this chart
- Bringing the wrong color into a fight = 0.5x damage output
- Bringing the right color = 2x damage output
- Party color diversity is rewarded, mono-color teams are punished in the wrong matchup

Realm & Color Interactions

- Certain realms amplify or suppress specific colors
- Heaven: TBD interaction with White
- Hell: TBD interaction with Black
- RGB Realm: TBD interaction with Red, Green, Blue
- BW Realm: TBD interaction with Black, White
- Details TBD per realm as they are developed

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5. CHARACTERS

The Original Four

Fighter

- Class: Warrior
- Name Origin: His class name. He doesn't question it.
- Personality: Cocky, self-aware about being a legend, genuinely just happy to be fighting again
- Colors: TBD (likely Red/White — aggression + protection)
- Resource Pool: Stamina (SP)
- Role: Frontline physical damage, story protagonist
- Battle Theme: Rivers in the Desert (FF7 Remake) — restrained power, deliberate, building. Reflects Fighter rediscovering his strength level by level.

- Power Note: Fighter genuinely atrophied from retirement — use it or lose it. The grind is real. Each level up is him rediscovering and then EXCEEDING what he was before.
- Notes: Fighter is the story's protagonist — not a player self-insert. He has his own personality, motivations, and arc. The player watches him, not projects onto him. The only original party member not named after their class — played as a joke about his intellect. He starts the whole thing by walking out of retirement out of sheer boredom.
- Visual Design (reference image confirmed):
  - Spiky red hair, red eyes
  - Shirtless — never wears a shirt, battle scars visible
  - Built Ford Tough — massive, jacked physique
  - Partial plate armor — shoulder pauldrons with fur trim, armored greaves, heavy boots
  - Skull belt buckle, chains on belt, utility pouches
  - Tattered red cape
  - Fingerless gauntlets / armored gloves
  - Weapon: oversized greatsword carried on shoulder like it weighs nothing
  - Expression: permanent smug grin, completely unbothered
  - Player 1 energy — looks like the main character and knows it

Thief

- Class: Assassin (Bot)
- Personality: Completely unbothered by everything. Calm. Efficient. Was a vacuum cleaner. Has no feelings about this.
- Backstory: Fired/blacklisted for 200% kill efficiency on limited-kill contracts. Sold to a pawn broker, purchased by a bandit leader who thought he was buying a vacuum cleaner.
- Colors: Red/Black (fire and unholy — fast, lethal, menacing)
- Resource Pool: Power (PWR)
- Role: High single-target damage, assassination mechanics, speed
- Battle Theme: Due Recompense (FF7 Remake) — sleek, precise, methodical, cold
- Notes: Loyal in the way a weapon is loyal. Running threat assessment log on every party member. Mage filed under "do not engage." Mage holding-back estimate: 8-15%, margin of error significant. In love with Cleric — literally went to the underworld and back for her. Has never mentioned this directly.

Cleric

- Class: Battle Healer
- Personality: Warm, fully committed, emotionally invested in everyone. Was actively searching for Thief when the party reunited. In love with Fighter who cannot or will not see it.
- Colors: TBD (likely White/Green or White/Black)
- Resource Pool: Mana (MP)
- Role: Heals but hits hard. Not a passive support.
- Battle Theme: Amy's Theme (Sonic) — warm, determined, runs toward the thing everyone else is running from
- Notes: The emotional backbone of the party. Finds Thief adorable in the way you find a very dedicated golden retriever adorable — warm but not romantic. Quietly grateful Mage is on their side. Gently steers people away before they call Mage a Wizard.

Mage

- Class: Mage. NOT a Wizard. Do not call him a Wizard.
- Personality: Fighter's best friend. The strongest in the realm — not just the room, the REALM — and his achievements regrettably reinforce this. Holds back constantly, by choice. Currently estimated at 8-15% actual capacity.
- Colors: TBD (likely Blue/Red — control and chaos)
- Resource Pool: Mana (MP)
- Role: Magic/elemental damage dealer. The actual ceiling of the party's power, deliberately suppressed.
- Battle Theme: "Move B*tch Get Out The Way" / "X Gon Give It To Ya" energy — arrives and owns the room, correct about everything, completely indifferent to how that makes everyone feel
- Holding Back: Mage holds back by choice. The party rags on him for it constantly. He does not change his behavior. "I'm at 12%." "Would you like me to demonstrate 13%?"
- The Wizard Issue: Dissolved the Wizard Ward. Founded the Mage Methodology in its place. Ran it for exactly one year. Left because administration kept getting in the way of learning spells. The Mage Methodology still exists and thrives. He has never returned. A building was named after him. He has not visited the building. The Wizard Ward also still technically exists somewhere. Nobody has told Mage. Nobody is going to tell Mage.
- Zone of Truth: Counterspells Zone of Truth on principle, every time, before the cast completes. Never looks up from his book.
- Party Dynamics:

    - Fighter: knows Mage is probably stronger, doesn't care, they're bros, moving on
    - Thief: highest threat assessment in the log, never mentioned
    - Cleric: quietly grateful, slightly terrified
    - Sorcerer: argues chaos magic is superior, Mage lets her be wrong, this makes her furious
    - Paladin: Zone of Truth attempt — counterspelled before cast completes, every time, on principle
- Notes: Fighter and Mage are bros. Bros bros bros. Previous friendly bout left Fighter simultaneously Poisoned, Paralyzed, Frightened, Cursed, Cold, and Burned. Fighter was grinning the entire time.

Henry Stickmin

- Origin: His own realm (shattered)
- Intro: Fell face-first out of the sky next to the party. Joined.
- Colors: TBD
- Resource Pool: NRG Drink (NRG)
- Role: TBD
- Notes: Just himself. Canonically present. Nobody questions it.

Full Roster — 21 Characters

Starting Party (Unlocked via Act 1)

#	Character	Type	Colors	Resource	Notes
1	Fighter	Original — Protagonist	TBD	TBD	Story protagonist, not a player avatar. Starts the whole thing by leaving retirement out of boredom.
2	Thief	Original — Assassin Bot	Red/Black	NRG	Was a vacuum cleaner. Unbothered.
3	Cleric	Original — Battle Healer	TBD	TBD	Hits hard, heals too. Emotional backbone.
4	Mage	Original — Mage	TBD	TBD	Fighter's best friend. Bros bros bros.

Story Join

#	Character	Type	Colors	Resource	Notes
5	Henry Stickmin	Inspired-By	TBD	TBD (Fails? Luck Tokens?)	Fell face-first from the sky. Joined. No explanation.

Class Roster (Unlocked via Node Clears)

#	Character	Type	Colors	Resource	Stat Focus	Notes
6	Warrior the Barbarian	Class Archetype	TBD	Stamina	HP + STR (low Stamina)	Tank/bruiser, burns resource fast but hits massive
7	Ranger the Ranger	Class Archetype	TBD	TBD	TBD	Three pets: Direwolf, Komodo (fire), Direhawk. Pet mechanic WIP
8	Monk the Monk	Class Archetype	TBD	TBD	DEX (highest in roster)	No weapons, fists only. Naturally hard to hit via high DEX
9	Warlock the Warlock	Class Archetype	TBD	TBD	TBD	Stronger raw spells than Mage, demonic familiars
10	Rogue the Rogue	Class Archetype	TBD	TBD	DEX (2nd highest)	Daggers only. Fast, bleed-focused.
11	Bard the Bard	Class Archetype	TBD	TBD	LCK (high)	Buffs allies via music and art. High LCK benefits whole party
12	Paladin the Paladin	Class Archetype	White/TBD	TBD	STR + WIS	SMITE signature move. Tank that heals and nukes holy damage
13	Artificer the Artificer	Class Archetype	TBD	TBD	INT (high)	Gun enthusiast and robot maker. Shares summon space with Ranger/Warlock
14	Sorcerer the Sorcerer	Class Archetype	TBD	TBD	LCK (high)	Consistent magic damage. More reliable than Mage, less volatile
15	Druid the Druid	Class Archetype	Green/TBD	TBD	TBD	Wild Shape mid-combat changes stat profile. Nature spells.

Inspired-By Roster (Unlocked via Node Clears)

#	Character	Inspired By	Colors	Resource	Stat Focus	Notes
16	Edward Elric	Full Metal Alchemist	Red/Green	TBD (Alchemy energy)	TBD	Automail arm + transmutation. Alters battlefield, creates weapons
17	Direwolf20 (Steve)	Minecraft / DW20	TBD	TBD	INT + STR (low LCK)	Gear/skills from his modpack. Endgame gear from Draconic Evolution
18	Link	Legend of Zelda	TBD	TBD	STR + DEX + WIS (low LCK)	Many attack items (WIP). Well-rounded physical fighter
19	Samus Aran	Metroid	TBD	TBD	Equipment-derived damage	Beam swapping modulates damage type. Power is gear-based not stat-based
20	Mario & Luigi	Super Mario	TBD	TBD	High all stats (low LCK)	Duo character. Bro Moves mechanic. Super Plumber fusion ultimate form

Final Unlock

#	Character	Inspired By	Colors	Resource	Stat Focus	Notes
21	Master Chief	Halo / 117	TBD	TBD	STR + LCK (high)	Recharging shield mechanic unique to him. Many guns. Last node unlock.

Secret Character (Unlock all 20 to reveal)

#	Character	Type	Colors	Resource	Stat Focus	Notes
22	ShootingDragon	Developer Insert	TBD	TBD	TBD (not strongest)	Magic mods kit. Endgame gear: Red Matter armor + Red Matter sword (EE2/ProjectE)

Villain Recruit

#	Character	Type	Colors	Resource	Notes
TBD	Sweetheart	Original — Villain Flip	TBD	TBD	Recurring antagonist. Recruitment conditions TBD.

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6. COMBAT SYSTEM

Overview

Turn-based combat inspired by Persona 5. Encounters are fast, readable, and reward smart play without being slow. Both sides occupy a 3x3 grid — positioning is a core mechanic that affects damage dealt, damage taken, and target access.

Party Structure

- **3 Active** characters on the field occupying positions on the player 3x3 grid
- **3 Reserve** characters on the bench (off grid)
- Reserve characters can act and swap freely — swapping does not cost a turn
- 3 active fills the 3x3 grid cleanly with meaningful positioning choices and no empty slots
- Characters choose their position within the grid — not all 9 slots need to be filled but 3 active characters place naturally without gaps looking bad

Turn Order

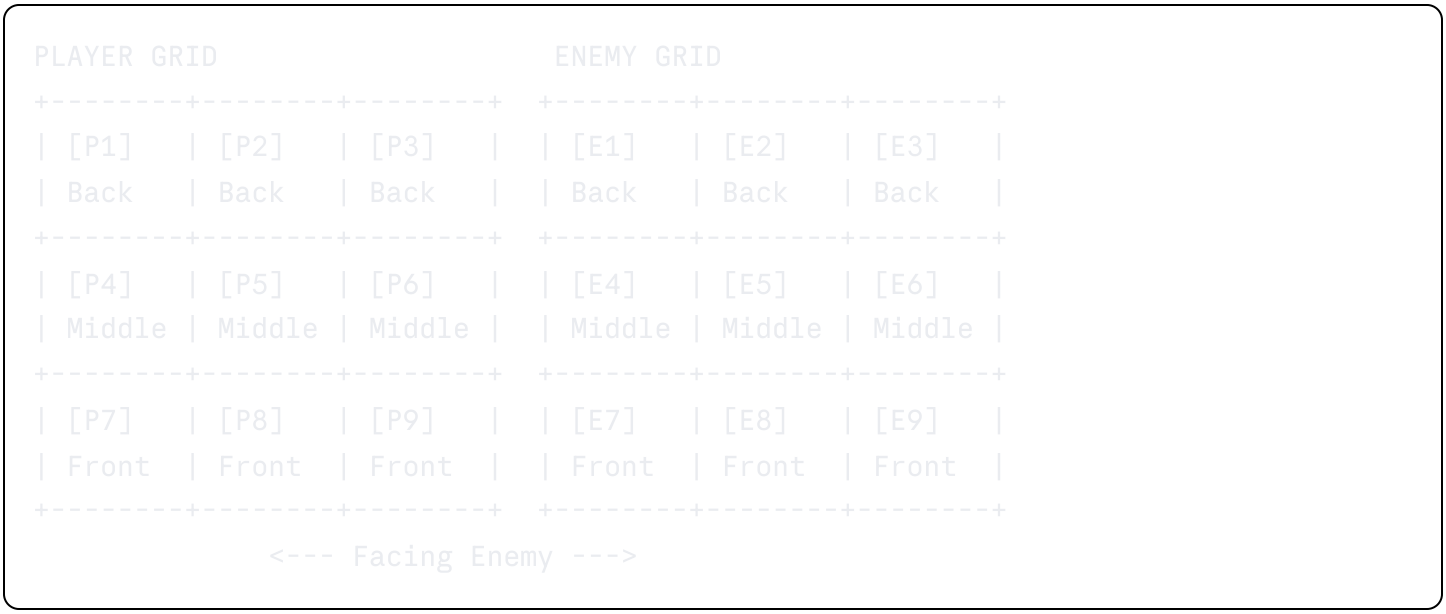
- Determined by Speed stat (derived — TBD exact formula)
- Status effects and skills can modify turn order

Action Menu (Per Turn)

- Attack — Basic physical attack
- Skill — Uses character's resource pool, belongs to a color
- Item — Use consumable from inventory
- Swap — Bring in a reserve character (free action)
- Move — Reposition on the grid (unlimited times per turn, free)
- Defend — Reduce incoming damage this turn
- Flee — Attempt escape (LCK influences success rate)

The 3x3 Combat Grid

Both the player party and enemies occupy their own 3x3 grid. The two grids face each other. Position on the grid affects damage output, damage received, and melee access.

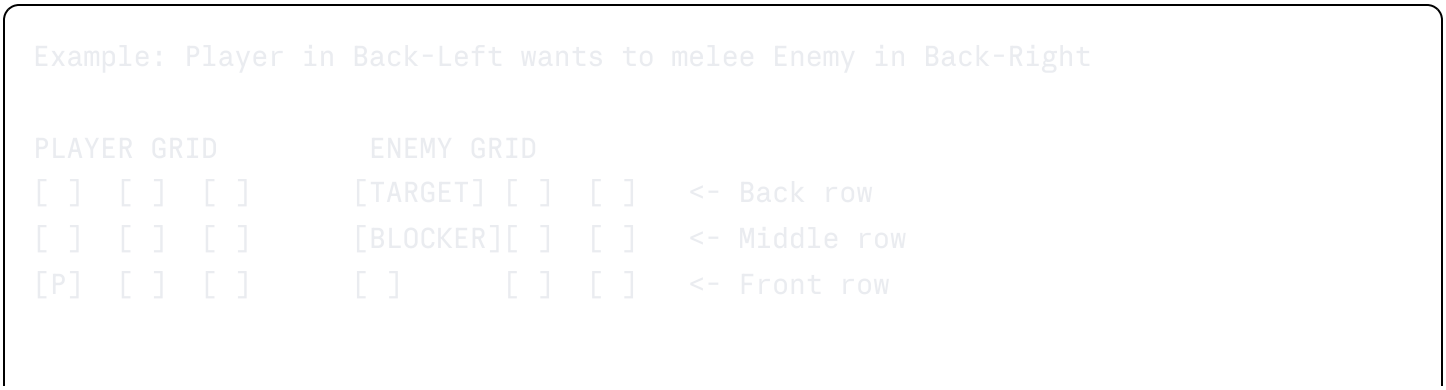


Row Positioning Modifiers

Row	Damage Dealt	Damage Taken	Notes
Front	+25%	+25%	High risk, high reward
Middle	Normal	Normal	Balanced position
Back	-25%	-25%	Safe but reduced output

Same rules apply to enemies — front row enemies hit harder and take more damage.

Melee Targeting Rules



```
BLOCKER occupies the same column between P and TARGET.
Melee bonus is denied. Attack still lands but at normal damage.
Remove BLOCKER first to unlock the bonus.
```

Melee Rules

- Can target ANY enemy on the grid — no hard range restriction
- Deals front row bonus damage (+25%) when attacking enemies in the closest row
- If an enemy occupies the same column between attacker and target — melee bonus is blocked
- Attack still connects at normal damage, bonus is just denied
- Clearing front column enemies opens up melee bonuses on back rows
- Movement is free and unlimited — reposition before attacking to find open columns

---

Ranged & Magic Targeting Rules

- Ranged (bows, guns) and Magic attacks can hit any grid position freely
- No column blocking mechanic — shots and spells go over or around obstacles
- No front row proximity bonus — distance is irrelevant for these attack types
- Row modifiers still apply to the TARGET (front row enemy still takes +25%)

Attack Categories

Every attack belongs to one of three categories:

- **Melee** — physical close combat, swords, fists, blades
- **Ranged** — bows, guns, thrown weapons (non-magic)
- **Magic** — spells, colored skills, elemental attacks

Attack category matters for Ward interactions (see below).

Wards

Magic enemies can cast wards that block an entire attack category for the whole party.

Standard Enemy Wards

- Block one category: Melee, Ranged, or Magic
- Affects the entire player party — not just one character
- Expire naturally after a set number of turns
- Can be broken early by ward-breaker skills
- Forces party to adapt and use unblocked attack types

Boss Ward Cycle Bosses don't use a single ward — they cycle through all three in a random order on a fixed timer.

```
BOSS WARD CYCLE EXAMPLE:

Turn 1-4:   [MAGIC BLOCKED]   [MELEE: OPEN]   [RANGED: OPEN]
Turn 5-8:   [RANGED BLOCKED]  [MELEE: OPEN]   [MAGIC: OPEN]
Turn 9-12:  [MELEE BLOCKED]   [RANGED: OPEN]  [MAGIC: OPEN]
Turn 13+:   Cycle repeats in new random order
```

- Order is **random** each fight — never the same sequence
- Timing is **fixed per boss tier:**

Boss Tier	Turns Per Ward	Notes
Early Game	4-5 turns	Forgiving, teaches the mechanic
Mid Game	3-4 turns	Tighter windows, more pressure
Late Game	2-3 turns	Fast rotation, constant adaptation
Endgame / Superboss	TBD	Probably brutal

- Ward-breaker skills can shatter active wards early
- Players MUST cover all three attack categories against bosses
- Mono-category parties will always have a window where they're shut down

---

Resource Pools

Each character has a uniquely named resource pool reflecting their identity:

- Fighter: Stamina (SP)

- Thief: Power (PWR)
- Cleric: Mana (MP)
- Mage: Mana (MP)
- Warrior: Stamina (STM)
- Henry Stickmin: NRG Drink (NRG)
- All others: TBD per character identity

Damage Types

- Physical — scales with ATK vs DEF, no color, belongs to Melee or Ranged category
- Magic/Elemental — scales with MAG vs MDEF, carries color type, belongs to Magic category
- Elemental affinity and color access granted by character identity and gear
- Enemy weaknesses and resistances apply to color types

Damage Calculation Formula

Physical Hit:

```
Base        = ATK - DEF
            = 0 if ATK ≤ DEF (fully blocked)
After Mods  = Base × Color Modifier × Crit Modifier
Final       = After Mods + (After Mods × Row Bonus)
```

Magic Hit:

```
Base        = MAG - MDEF
            = 0 if MAG ≤ MDEF (fully blocked)
After Mods  = Base × Color Modifier × Crit Modifier
Final       = After Mods + (After Mods × Row Bonus)
```

DEF is strictly physical only. MDEF is strictly magic only. No crossover.

Modifier Values:

Modifier	Value	Notes
Color Weakness	×2.0	Attacker's color beats defender's
Color Resistance	×0.5	Defender resists attacker's color
Color Neutral	×1.0	No interaction
Critical Hit	×2.0	Doubles final damage
Front Row	+25% additive	Applied after crit/color
Middle Row	+0%	No modifier
Back Row	-25% additive	Applied after crit/color

Stacking example — front row + weakness + crit: `Base × 2.0 (weak) × 2.0 (crit) = 4× base, then +25% additive = 5× effective`

Blocked attack: If ATK - DEF ⩽ 0, damage = 0. Defense is a real wall, not a soft reduction.

Enemy HP Scaling

Enemy HP scales dynamically based on average player damage at that level rather than fixed values. This ensures the ratio of hits-to-kill stays consistent regardless of level.

Formula: `Enemy Total HP = Average Player Damage at Level × HP Ratio`

Enemy Type	HP Ratio	Notes
Common (Early)	×5	3-6 hits to kill
Elite (Mid)	×12	8-15 hits to kill
Heavy (Late)	×20	Tanky, built tough
Early Boss	×35	2 health bars
Mid Boss	×60	3 health bars
Late Boss (Echo Tau)	×120	4 health bars

Why ratio scaling: Numbers will reach hundreds of thousands at high levels and that is fine. Disgaea logic applies — the ratio staying consistent is what matters, not the raw number.

Boss Health Bars & Phase Transitions

Bosses have multiple health bars. Each bar break is a phase transition — a natural pause where the boss reacts, shifts behavior, and escalates.

Boss Tier	Health Bars
Early (Sweetheart tier)	2 bars
Mid (Realm Warden tier)	3 bars
Late (Echo Tau tier)	4 bars
Endgame / New Tabuu	TBD — probably a lot

Phase transition events (per boss, handcrafted individually):

- New random ward cycle begins
- New attack patterns unlock
- Boss dialogue / story reaction
- Visual change — sprite, aura, color shift
- Desperation mechanics on final bar (shorter ward timers, higher damage, unique moves)

Each boss's phases are designed individually to feel handcrafted rather than templated. The framework provides the structure, the personality fills it in.

---

7. STAT SYSTEM

Overview

Stats are split into two categories: Allocated and Derived. Players manually spend points into Allocated stats every level. Derived stats are calculated automatically from Allocated stats and gear. This gives players direct control over how each character grows.

Level Up Allocation

- Every level grants 10 points to spend freely across Allocated stats
- HP and Resource pools gain +10 per 1 point invested
- All other Allocated stats gain +1 per 1 point invested

- No cap — characters level forever, allocation never stops

Passive Stat Growth Per Level

In addition to the player's 10 allocated points, each character automatically gains bonus stats every level reflecting their identity. These are fixed and cannot be changed.

Original Four

Character	HP	Resource	STR	DEX	WIS	INT	LCK	Resource Name
Fighter	+20	—	+5	—	—	—	—	TBD
Thief	—	+10	—	+5	—	—	+1	Power (PWR)
Mage	—	+20	—	—	—	+5	—	Mana (MP)
Cleric	+20	+10	+2	—	+1	+1	—	Mana (MP)

Full Roster Passive Growth (TBD)

#	Character	HP	Resource	STR	DEX	WIS	INT	LCK	Resource Name
5	Henry Stickmin	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD
6	Warrior the Barbarian	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	Stamina (STM)
7	Ranger the Ranger	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD
8	Monk the Monk	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD
9	Warlock the Warlock	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD
10	Rogue the Rogue	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD
11	Bard the Bard	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD
12	Paladin the Paladin	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD
13	Artificer the Artificer	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD
14	Sorcerer the Sorcerer	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD
15	Druid the Druid	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD
16	Edward Elric	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD
17	Direwolf20 (Steve)	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD
18	Link	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD
19	Samus	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD
20	Mario & Luigi	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD
21	Master Chief	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD
22	ShootingDragon	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD
—	Sweetheart	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD

Allocated Stats

Stat	Abbrev	Effect
Hit Points	HP	+10 HP per point invested

Stat	Abbrev	Effect
[Resource Name]	varies per character	+10 Resource per point invested
Strength	STR	Drives physical damage (ATK), contributes to DEF
Dexterity	DEX	Drives speed (SPD), contributes to CRIT and CRIT DMG
Wisdom	WIS	Drives healing power, contributes to DEF and RES
Intelligence	INT	Drives magic damage (MAG), contributes to RES
Luck	LCK	Affects drop rates, status chance, contributes to CRIT and CRIT DMG

Derived Stats

Calculated automatically from Allocated stats and gear. Exact formulas TBD in Godot.

Stat	Abbrev	Source
Attack	ATK	Derived from STR
Magic Attack	MAG	Derived from INT
Defense	DEF	Derived from STR + WIS
Resistance	RES	Derived from WIS + INT
Critical Chance	CRIT	Derived from DEX + LCK
Critical Damage	CRIT DMG	Derived from DEX + LCK (separate formula)
Speed	SPD	Derived from DEX

Gear Interaction

- Gear adds flat bonuses on top of derived stats
- Gear can also boost Allocated stats directly (e.g. +5 STR on a weapon)
- Color affinity granted by character identity and gear

---

8. LOOT SYSTEM

Rarity Tiers (Borderlands-inspired)

Tier	Color	Notes
Common	White	Basic stats, no special effects
Uncommon	Green	Minor bonuses
Rare	Blue	Notable stat bumps
Epic	Purple	Special effects begin appearing
Legendary	Orange/Gold	Unique effects, build-defining
TBD	TBD	Post-legendary ultra-rare (TBD)

Item Types

- Weapons — Scale ATK or MAG, may reinforce color affinity
- Armor — Scale DEF, RES, HP
- Accessories — Flexible slot, any stat, special effects
- Each character has their own gear slots

Drop Logic

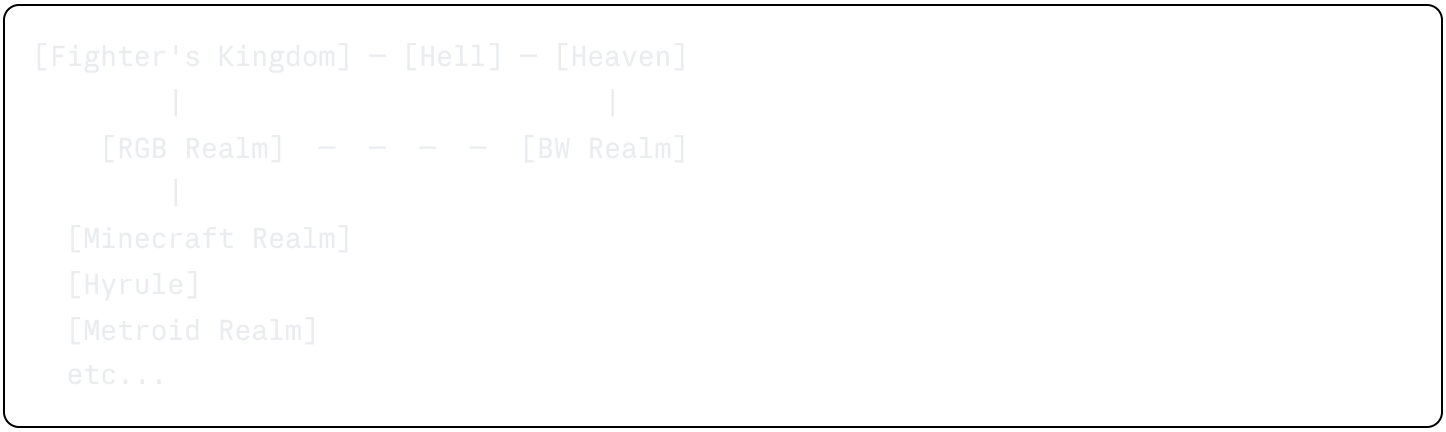
- Enemies drop loot on defeat
- LCK stat influences drop rate and rarity chance
- Node bosses have guaranteed drops / higher rarity floors
- TBD — crafting system, loot trading between characters

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9. WORLD MAP & PROGRESSION

Map Structure — Three Layers

Layer 1 — The Shattered Realms (Main Map) The top level overview. Every realm is a single node connected by paths. Abstract, stylized — glowing nodes connected by lines, not a literal painted world. Camera zooms smoothly to selected realm then transitions to its sub map.



Layer 2 — Realm Sub Map Each realm has its own abstract node network. Nodes are connected by paths, locked until prerequisites are cleared. Camera zooms between nodes as the player travels. Each node has a type that determines what happens when you enter it.

Fighter's Kingdom example:



Layer 3 — Locations Some nodes expand into their own screen when entered rather than going straight to battle.

Node Types

Type	Description
Combat	Straight into battle. Most common node type.
Town	Opens a town with merchants, smith, inn, NPCs. No combat.
Dungeon	Mini dungeon map — multiple rooms, random encounters, treasure, boss at the end.
Story	Cutscene or dialogue. No combat. Drives the narrative.
Boss	Single boss fight. Gates progression to next area.
Character	Rescue a frozen legend. Boss fight followed by character unlock.

Town Contents

Every town node contains some or all of:

- **Merchant** — buy and sell gear, consumables
- **Smith** — upgrade weapons and armor
- **Inn** — rest and recover full HP and resources
- **Notice Board** — optional bounty quests (TBD)
- **NPCs** — flavor dialogue, lore, character reactions

Dungeon Structure

- Series of rooms connected on a mini map
- Random encounters trigger as you move through rooms
- Treasure chests with loot
- Boss room at the end — required to complete the dungeon
- Better rewards than regular combat nodes
- Random encounters pull from the realm's enemy pool — same battle system, no extra work

---

Node Data (Reusable Code Structure)

Every node in the game uses the same `NodeData` resource. Change the values, completely different node. Same code runs all of them.

```gdscript
```

```
class_name NodeData
extends Resource

@export var node_name: String = ""
@export var node_type: String = ""        # combat, town, dungeon, story, boss, chara
@export var unlock_cost: int = 0          # currency cost to enter
@export var unlock_requirement: String = "" # what node must be cleared first
@export var enemy_pool: Array = []        # what enemies can appear
@export var boss_id: String = ""          # which boss guards this node
@export var reward_xp: int = 0
@export var reward_gold: int = 0
@export var is_completed: bool = false
```

Camera Travel

When the player selects a node the camera smoothly zooms to it before the node triggers. Works on both the main map and realm sub maps. Gives the world physical presence without needing open world exploration.

gdscript

```
var tween = create_tween()
tween.tween_property(camera, "position", target_node.position, 0.8)
await tween.finished
# trigger node
```

Optional additions: slight zoom in during travel, path highlighting as camera moves.

Realm Unlock Order

1. Fighter's Kingdom (start)
2. TBD mid-game realms
3. Heaven (mid game, after shattering event)
4. Hell (mid game, after shattering event)
5. RGB Realm (after clearing Heaven and Hell)
6. BW Realm (after clearing Heaven and Hell)
7. Late game realms TBD

Difficulty Scaling

- Nodes have recommended power levels
- Uncapped leveling means you can always over-grind and return
- TBD — endgame node variants (Steel Path equivalent)

---

10. ROSTER SYSTEM

How It Works

- Fighter, Mage, Cleric, Thief are the starting four (unlocked through Act 1)
- Henry Stickmin joins via story event after Mage rejoins the party
- Characters 6–20 unlock by clearing their associated world map node
- Character 21 (Master Chief) is the final node unlock — hardest in the game
- Character 22 (ShootingDragon) is secret — unlocked after recruiting all 20 prior characters
- Sweetheart is a villain recruit — conditions TBD
- Each character has their own stat growth rate (TBD per character), level, gear slots, skill tree, passives, resource pool, and color identity

Party Building

- Select 3 active + 3 reserve before entering a node
- Full flexibility — no locked-in compositions
- Color synergies and realm passives create meaningful party decisions

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11. TECHNICAL NOTES (Godot 4)

Engine & Tools

- **Engine:** Godot 4.6.1 stable
- **Language:** GDScript
- **Project Name:** GrindRPG (working title)
- **Character Art:** Blockbench (voxel) — non-Minecraft characters get stylized non-blocky voxel builds
- **Minecraft Realm Art:** Blockbench (blocky Minecraft aesthetic)

- **Sprite/UI Art:** Piskel (2.5D pixel art)
- **Icon Assets:** Clockwork Raven Fantasy Icons (purchased, commercial license)
- **Enemy Placeholders:** Pipoya Free RPG Monster Pack (free, commercial license)
- **Music:** Royalty free packs (placeholder) — original tracks for key moments TBD
- **Single developer**

Planned Structure

- CharacterData — Resource class: stats, skills, gear slots, resource pool, color identity
- BattleManager — Turn order, action resolution, swap logic, win/loss, realm passive application
- ColorSystem — Color type chart, weakness/resistance lookups
- WorldMap — Node grid, lock/unlock state, realm management
- LootGenerator — Rarity rolls, stat generation, drop tables
- RosterManager — Party selection, character unlock tracking

Build Order (Phases)

1. ✅ Character data structure (CharacterData resource — DONE)
2. ✅ Basic battle scene — Fighter vs Bandit, damage formula, turn order, victory/defeat (DONE)
3. Visual combat — HP bars on screen, combat log UI
4. Full combat depth — all 4 original characters, 3+3 swap system, skills, color system
5. Loot system — rarity, item generation, equipping, weapon bonuses
6. World map — nodes, regions, lock/unlock, currency cost
7. Roster system — unlocking characters via node clears
8. Story layer — dialogue system, Act 1 + Shattering sequence

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12. RELEASE ROADMAP

Philosophy

Ship the core experience first. Each update is a self-contained content drop. Sequels are a fresh roster and setting — not a continuation. AOSR is the full vision, delivered in stages.

Launch — The Original Four

- Fighter, Thief, Cleric, Mage playable
- Fighter's Kingdom — full node map, Act 1 complete
- Core loop polished — combat, loot, leveling, node progression
- Story ends at The Shattering — sky cracks, Henry falls out, credits roll
- Sweetheart as final boss
- Target: itch.io release

Update 1 — Henry Stickmin

- Henry Stickmin added with his NRG Drink resource and gadget kit
- Additional nodes and content for Fighter's Kingdom

Update 2 — Hell Dimension

- Hell realm unlocked with own node map
- Hell-specific enemies and bosses
- Black color amplified realm passive
- Legends from Hell realm unlockable

Update 3 — Heaven Dimension

- Heaven realm unlocked
- White color amplified realm passive
- Heaven vs Hell lore expanded
- Legends from Heaven realm unlockable

Update 4 — RGB & BW Dimensions

- RGB Realm — vibrant chaos, Red/Green/Blue interactions
- BW Realm — cold and calculated, Black/White interactions
- Both released together as thematic opposites

Future Updates

- Minecraft Realm (DW20, CaptainSparklez, ShootingDragon) — pending creator permissions
- Hyrule Realm (Link, Zelda, Ganon etc) — pending creator permissions

- Metroid Realm (Samus, Dark Samus) — pending creator permissions
- Military Realm (Master Chief) — pending creator permissions
- Additional class roster characters
- Endgame node variants

Permission Strategy

Reach out to creators AFTER MVP is playable. Show something real, not just a plan. Personalized messages referencing their specific content. If permission denied, replace with original inspired-by character.

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13. MONSTERPEDIA (Working Title)

Overview

An in-game bestiary that tracks every enemy the player has encountered. Each entry is written from the perspective of one party member — chosen for maximum personality fit with that specific enemy. One voice per monster, curated, characterful.

Unlock System

- **Seen** — entry unlocks on first encounter. Shows silhouette only, name, and "???" for stats.
- **Defeated** — full entry unlocks after first defeat. Shows stats, weaknesses, resistances, drop table.
- **Complete** — all data filled in after multiple encounters.

Entry Structure

Each monster entry contains:

- **Name**
- **Description** — brief flavor text about the enemy
- **Character Note** — one line from a specific party member's perspective
- **Stats** — HP ratio, DEF, MDEF, ATK
- **Color Weaknesses** — what colors deal 2x damage
- **Color Resistances** — what colors deal 0.5x damage
- **Drop Table** — what loot they can drop and at what rarity
- **Realm** — which realm they come from

Shiny Encounters

A small chance on any enemy encounter to spawn a shiny version — visually distinct, significantly stronger, but much more rewarding.

Shiny Stats (applied at runtime via code — no separate data files needed):

- HP: ×2
- ATK: ×2
- DEF/MDEF: ×2
- Gold dropped: ×3
- XP rewarded: ×3
- Drop rolls: ×2 (rolls the drop table twice)

Encounter Rate:

- Base chance: 2% per encounter
- LCK influences rate — higher party average LCK = higher shiny chance
- Formula: `shiny_chance = 0.02 + (party_avg_lck × 0.001)`
- Soft cap TBD — never guaranteed but meaningfully farmable with LCK builds

Visual Identity (must be immediately recognizable):

- Bright glowing outline or aura
- Color shifted from normal version
- Particle effect sparkling around them
- Distinct sound cue on spawn
- Player should know it's a shiny before reading any stats

Technical Implementation:

- One enemy data file per enemy type — normal version only
- On battle load, roll `randf() < shiny_chance`
- If shiny — load normal data, call `apply_shiny()`, swap visual
- `apply_shiny()` handles all multipliers universally
- Every enemy gets shiny support automatically — no manual setup per enemy

Monsterpedia: Shiny versions have their own separate entry — discovered and completed independently from the normal version.

Confirmed Entries

Bandit

- Realm: Fighter's Kingdom
- Note character: Fighter
- *"Some guys who pillage villages, not worth the ink to remember."*
- — Fighter

Design Notes

- The character chosen to write each entry should be the one with the most interesting or funny reaction to that specific enemy
- Notes are discovered gradually as you recruit more characters — early game you only have the original four's voices available
- Henry Stickmin's notes are probably just a drawing
- Sorcerer's entries may reference taste
- Paladin's entries are extremely thorough and legally admissible as testimony
- Mage's entries are technically correct and slightly condescending

Technical Implementation

- Same structure as CharacterDB — a singleton holding all enemy data resources
- EnemyData resource class similar to CharacterData
- Monsterpedia UI — scrollable grid, greyed out undiscovered entries, full entry on tap
- Tracks seen/defeated/complete state per enemy per save file

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14. UNLEASH SYSTEM

Overview

A desperation/rage bar that fills as characters take damage. The lower the HP the faster it fills. When full the player can trigger a character's unique Unleash move — a powerful, personality-defining attack that's been building the whole fight.

The Bar

- **Name:** Unleash
- **Capacity:** 200 points (adjustable)
- **Fill Rate:** 1 point minimum per hit, up to 50 points maximum per hit
- **Scaling:** The lower the character's HP the more points gained per hit
- **Target fill time:** 5-7 rounds of taking damage
- **Trigger:** Manual — player selects Unleash as an action when bar is full
- **UI:** Unleash button lights up / becomes available when bar reaches 200

Point Gain Formula

gdscript

```gdscript
func get_unleash_points(damage_taken: int, current_hp: int, max_hp: int) -> int:
    var hp_percent = float(current_hp) / float(max_hp)
    var base_points = damage_taken * 0.5
    var desperation_bonus = (1.0 - hp_percent) * 50
    return int(clamp(base_points + desperation_bonus, 1, 50))
```

- **Full HP** — slow fill, base points only
- **50% HP** — desperation bonus kicks in noticeably
- **25% HP** — filling fast, getting dangerous
- **Near death** — almost maxing per hit

Design Intent

Players who take risks and absorb damage fill the bar faster. Defending constantly is safe but delays access to Unleash. Risk and reward baked into the core loop.

Confirmed Unleash Moves

Fighter — Reckoning

Select one primary target. That target receives 200% of Fighter's normal attack damage, hit 10 times. All other enemies receive 90% of each hit as collateral damage. Fighter doesn't try to clear the field — he makes a point about one specific enemy and everyone else just happens to be nearby.

Thief — Overclock

Multi-hit single target attack. Steals 3 items from the target. Efficient as always — why waste a trip.

Cleric — Last Rites

Phase 1: Cleric nukes the entire field with unholy magic — ALL allies are reduced to 1 HP.
Phase 2: Immediately full heals all allies.
The risk window between Phase 1 and Phase 2 is intentional. She trusts herself completely. If something interrupts the heal, that's a very bad day. Battle cleric energy at its absolute peak.

Mage — "I THINK THE FUCK NOT"

Nukes all enemies using the full might of arcana. No formal move name. No charge up. No dramatic pose. He looks up from his book for exactly one second, raises his staff, says the words, everything dies, returns to reading. The damage output is not discussed in polite company.
Visual reference: unbothered wizard energy. This is Tuesday for him.

PLANNED FUTURE MECHANIC — Attack Type Triangle (RPS System)

To be implemented after core battle system is stable.

Overview

A Rock Paper Scissors layer on top of the existing color weakness/resistance system. Inspired by Monster Hunter Stories. Each enemy has a current stance — hitting them with the right attack type deals bonus damage on top of color modifiers.

The Triangle

Power → Technical → Speed → Power

- **Power** — heavy hits, slow, beats Technical
- **Speed** — fast multi-hits, beats Power
- **Technical** — precise, status focused, beats Speed

How It Interacts With Existing Systems

A hit gets evaluated in order:

1. Base damage (ATK/MAG vs DEF/MDEF)
2. Color modifier (weakness/resistance)
3. Attack type modifier (RPS matchup)
4. Row bonus

5. Crit

Best case scenario — front row, color weakness, correct attack type, crit — results in massive damage. High skill expression reward.

Enemy Stance

- Enemies have a current stance that cycles or reacts to player actions
- Wrong type = reduced damage or enemy counter
- Correct type = bonus damage multiplier (TBD)
- Stance is visible to the player — readable from enemy behavior or UI indicator

Implementation Note

The damage formula already supports adding another multiplier step. No structural changes needed — just add the stance check alongside the color check when ready.

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15. OPEN QUESTIONS (TBD)

- [x] Fighter's resource pool name — Stamina (SP)
- [x] Mage's resource pool name — Mana (MP)
- [x] Cleric's resource pool name — Mana (MP)
- [ ] Cleric's personality
- [ ] Fighter, Mage, Cleric confirmed color pairs
- [ ] Henry Stickmin's color pair
- [x] Henry Stickmin's resource pool — NRG Drink (NRG)
- [ ] Specific realm unique rules for Heaven, Hell, RGB, BW
- [ ] Derived stat formulas (ATK, MAG, DEF, RES, CRIT, CRIT DMG, SPD) — nail down in Godot
- [ ] Skill tree structure — how many skills per character, unlock method
- [ ] Post-Legendary rarity tier
- [ ] Crafting system
- [ ] Endgame node variants (Steel Path equivalent)
- [ ] Full BBeg lore and identity
- [ ] Sweetheart's full arc and recruitment conditions
- [ ] Full world map scope and realm count
- [ ] Story beats beyond Act 1
